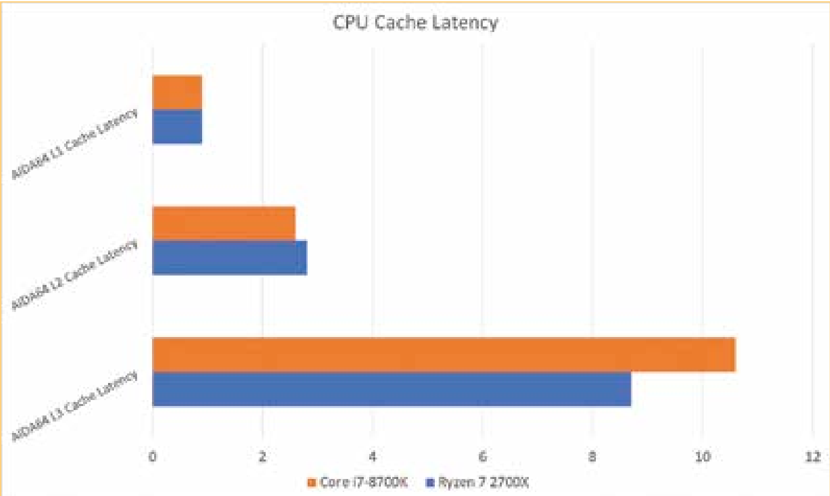
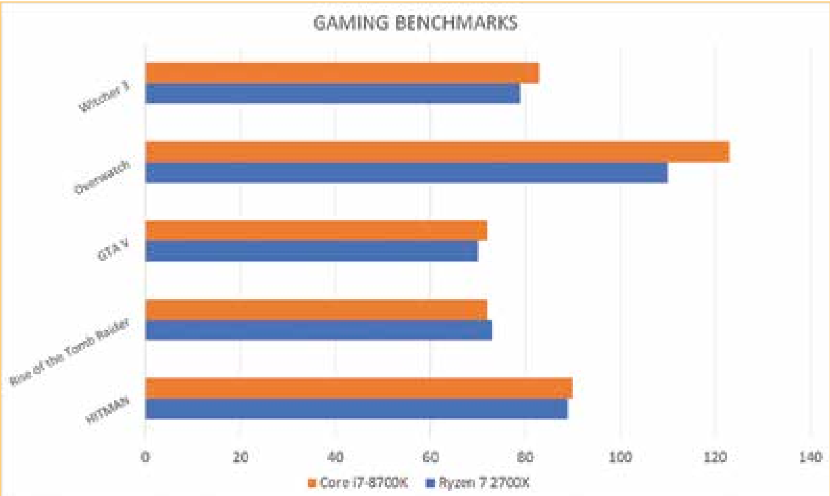
Aston Martin revives Superleggera
Aston Martin dubs the next-generation DBS as the DBS Superleggera to ensure the historic name lives on. **https://dgit.in/ashmartin**

WhatsApp catches drug dealers
A WhatsApp photo of fingerprints was used to track down a drug dealer and arrest 11 other members of the drug ring in Wales, UK. **https://dgit.in/whtsapp**





POV-Ray being a multi-threaded benchmark sees the Ryzen 7 2700X excel but it comes very close to the Intel Core i7-8700K. In our tests, the lead was just 2%. We then ran our Handbrake benchmark which basically consists of transcoding a 4K video clip from one CODEC to another without changing the resolution. Handbrake is quick to incorporate new CPU encoding engines and has the Intel CPU leading in the test. The 2700X is not left far behind and comes in as a close second to the 8700K.

We then used Blender which is a fairly well known open-source rendering software. In this benchmark, we're looking at the time taken for a run to finish rendering. So the CPU with the lower score in this test is the better one. The 2700X finished the run earlier than the 8700K with a difference of 41 seconds. That's a pretty impressive gain even when compared to the older 1800X. Over the past year, we've been receving a lot of requests from content creators for PC configurations and it seems that the 2700X is going to be recommended from now on.

We've stopped using PCMark 8 for our CPU tests with the advent of the newer PCMark 10 benchmark. For our tests we do not run PCMark 10 in its default state. We turn off OpenCL to ensure that the IGP/GPU doesn't affect the benchmark run. The delta in this case was 194 points with the 2700X in the lead.

One of the things that AMD said they'd improved in Ryzen 2nd Gen was the cache latency and in AIDA64's cache tests we can see the claimed improvement in cache latency in the 2700X. The numbers are practically equal to the Intel CPU, especially L1 and L2 cache latencies.

Lastly, in the compression and de-compression benchmark within 7-Zip, the Ryzen 7 2700X can be seen with a significant lead. It appears that 7-Zip is more core-conscious as compared to the older WinRAR benchmark.

GAMING PERFORMANCE

For gaming, we went with HITMAN, Rise of the Tomb Raider, GTA V, Overwatch and Witcher 3. The Intel Core i7-8700K scored 90, 72, 72, 123 and 83 FPS in the above mentioned titles while the Ryzen 7 2700X scored 89,73, 70, 110, 79 FPS in the same order. Compared to the older 1800X, this is a pretty significant improvement in performance. However, the Intel Core i7-8700K is still in the lead by a small margin.

CONCLUSION

AMD's latest desktop flagship certainly has all the bells and whistles that they promised. For most folks who've been sceptical of moving to a new platform, a revision or an optimised iteration is what they're looking out for. One which improves upon the drawbacks of the previous generation to provide a more streamlined performance across all use cases. Ryzen 7 2700X comes ahead of the Intel 8700K in all multi-threaded tasks but even with the improvements to the whole manufacturing process and the microarchitecture, single threaded performance isn't exceeding that of Intel. But that's not to say that it hasn't improved, it certainly has managed to even the scales. The gaming performance of the new CPUs is just about at par with Intel CPUs so all gamers who held out on getting the Ryzen CPUs can certainly take the plunge now. The only issue right now is that the Indian prices don't match the International pricing, so we don't expect the same sales for the new Ryzen 7 2700X as the Intel Core i7-8700K. For everything else, they're "practically" twins.